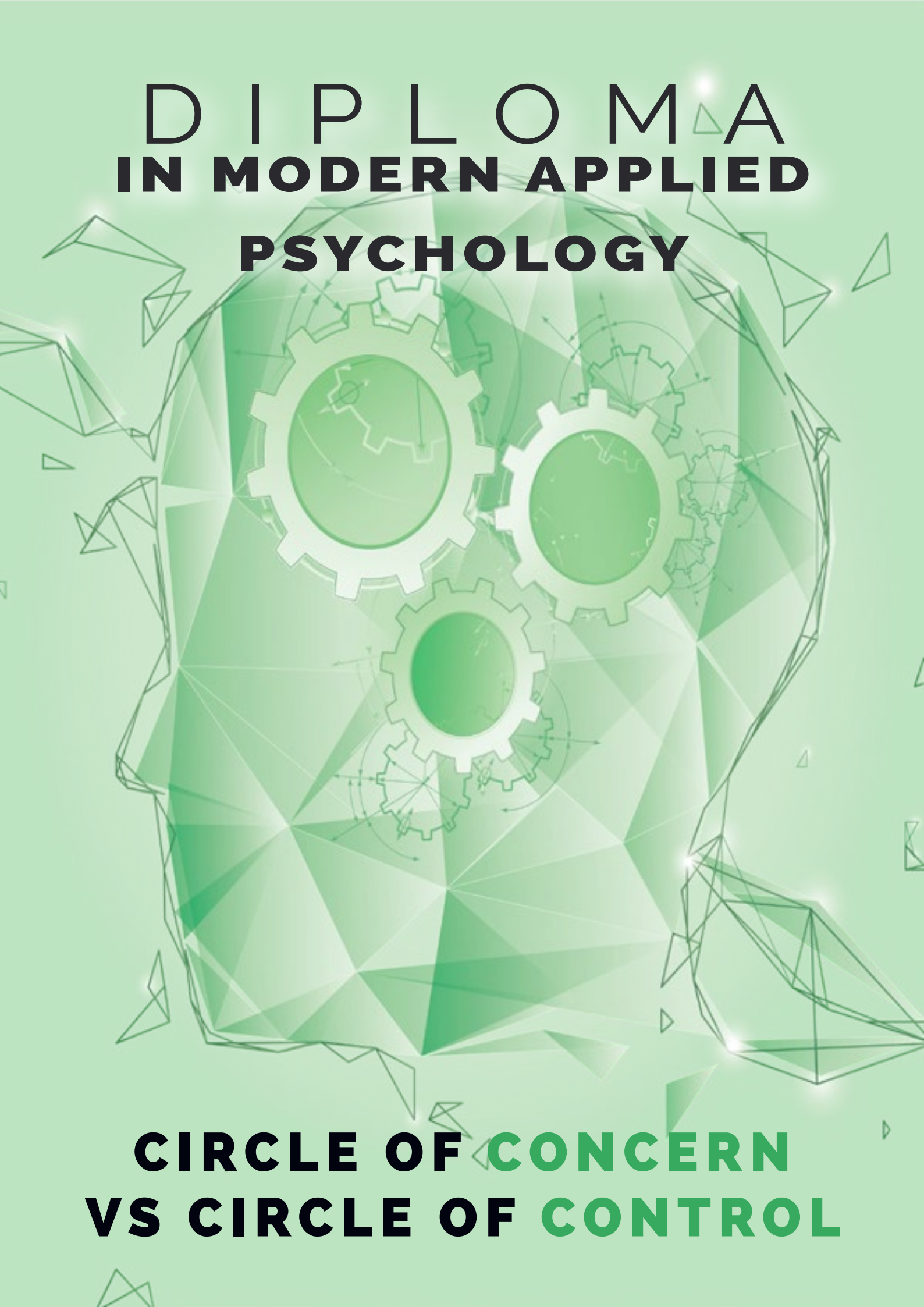


DIPLOMA IN MODERN APPLIED PSYCHOLOGY

The background is a light green field filled with a complex, low-poly geometric pattern. Overlaid on this are several interlocking gears of different sizes, rendered in a slightly darker green. Thin, dark green lines and arrows crisscross the scene, suggesting a network or a system of interconnected parts. The overall aesthetic is modern and technical.

**CIRCLE OF CONCERN
VS CIRCLE OF CONTROL**

CIRCLE OF CONCERN VS CIRCLE OF CONTROL

The circle of concern vs the circle of control is a variation of Rotter's locus of control. The two circles help us identify how we are showing up in life: whether we're impacting the world or being impacted by it (i.e. are you an influencer or the influenced). The models help us identify those who are reactors in life (i.e. victims) from those who are proactive in life (with their decisions, choices, outcomes, results, behaviours and consequences).



The circle of concern represents what our energy looks like when we focus on other people: be they celebrities we idolise, social media influencers or our peers. We allow these external influencers to influence what we wear, eat, do, where we work, what we say yes and no to, what we stand for and what we like and dislike. There are people who live their lives in fear because of what they read on the news whilst others never leave their hometowns because they don't want to upset their family or try something new and daring. Most people who fall into this bracket are mainly influenced by the fear of not conforming, i.e. they're paranoid of what people may think of them if they were to dress, act or be the way they want to be.

Those who are driven by their own goals, vision, standards and values regardless of the standards of other people show up in the circle of control. People who fall into this circle are those who are no longer controlled or governed by what external factors thin say or do. They accept that they cannot control the news, what's trending, other people's opinions, the weather, threats, what happens or the economy but they can control what they buy, where they work, how they feel, how they behave and respond, what they do and where they live. They are empowered enough to make congruent decisions out of the circle of control: they choose what boundaries they set, where they go, what they like and don't like, what they believe and what their attitudes are.



ROTTERS LOCUS OF CONTROL SCALE

The Principle of 'Locus of Control' was coined by Julian Rotter (1954). It considers the idea that people tend to either believe that control lives internally (within them) or externally (with others or the situation). This is, of course, a spectrum. Some individuals have a wholly internal or external locus of control, but others will have some balance between the two. For example, some people may be more internal at home while more external at work.



CIRCLE OF CONCERN VS CIRCLE OF CONTROL

Internal: those with a high internal locus of control believe in their own ability to control themselves and influence their outside world. They see themselves as being in control of their future and acknowledge that the choices they make will lead to their success or failure. Their belief in their own ability to change things may well lead to increased confidence levels, and they will look for information that will help them to influence people and situations. They are also likely to be more motivated and driven by success.

External: those with a high external locus of control believe that they personally have little or no control over events and what other people do. They may even believe that other people have control over them and that they can't do anything but obey.

People with an external locus of control are usually fatalistic. They see things from the perspective that life and events are just happening to them and there's very little that they can do about it. This tends to make them fairly passive and accepting. If they feel they've succeeded in something, they'll be more likely to attribute this to luck as supposed to their own skill/talent.

This is a questionnaire that will help you to determine where your locus of control lies. Each question consists of a pair of alternatives (a or b). Please select the statement from each pair which you more strongly believe to be true. Ensure that you chose the one you actually believe to be more true, as supposed to the one that you think you should choose or the one you would like to be true. Remember, this questionnaire is a measure of personal belief, so there are no right or wrong answers here.

Consider your answers carefully but don't spend too much time on each one. In some questions, you may find that you believe both statements or neither one to be true. In this case, just select the one that you more strongly believe to be true. Lastly, try to respond to each question independently when making your choice; don't allow yourself to be influenced by your previous choices.

1. **a.** Children end up getting into trouble because their parents punish them too much.
b. The problem with the majority of children today is that their parents are too easy on them.
2. **a.** Many of the unhappy things in individual's lives are partly due to bad luck.
b. Individual's misfortunes result from the mistakes they make.
3. **a.** One of the primary reasons why we have wars is because individuals don't take sufficient interest in politics.
b. There will always be wars, regardless of how much people try to prevent them.
4. **a.** In the long run, individuals get the respect they deserve in this world.
b. Unfortunately, an individual's worth often goes unrecognised no matter how hard they try.
5. **a.** The idea that teachers are unfair to students is ridiculous.
b. Most students do not realise the extent to which their grades/results are influenced by accidental happenings.
6. **a.** Without the right breaks, an individual cannot be an effective leader.
b. Capable people who fail to become leaders have not taken advantage of the opportunities they were presented with.



CIRCLE OF CONCERN VS CIRCLE OF CONTROL

- 7. a.** It doesn't matter how much you try, some people just won't ever like you.
b. People who can't get others to like them don't understand how to get along with others.
- 8. a.** Heredity plays a major role in determining a person's personality.
b. It is an individual's experiences in life which determine what they are like.
- 9. a.** I have frequently found that what's going to happen will happen.
b. Trusting in fate has never worked out as well for me as making a decision to take a definite course of action.
- 10. a.** In the case of a well-prepared student, there is rarely, if ever, what would be known as an unfair test.
b. It is frequently the case that exam questions tend to be so unrelated to course work that studying is actually useless.
- 11. a.** Becoming a success is a result of hard work, luck has very little or nothing to do with it.
b. Getting a good job is mostly about being in the right place at the right time.
- 12. a.** An average citizen can have an influence on governmental decisions.
b. This world is run by those few that are in power, and there's not much that the little guy can do about it.
- 13. a.** When I make plans, I'm almost positive that I can make them work.
b. It's not always wise to plan too far in advance because many things turn out to be a case of good or bad luck anyway.
- 14. a.** There are some people who are just no good.
b. There is some good in everyone.
- 15. a.** In my case, getting what I want has very little or nothing to do with luck.
b. Many times we might as well just decide what to do by tossing a coin.
- 16. a.** Who gets to be the boss usually depends on who was fortunate enough to be in the right place first.
b. Getting individuals to do the right thing depends upon ability. Luck has very little or nothing to do with it.
- 17. a.** In terms of world affairs, most of us are victims of forces we can neither understand or control.
b. By playing an active role in political and social affairs, people can control world events.
- 18. a.** The majority of people don't realise the extent to which their lives are controlled by accidental happenings.
b. There really is no such thing as 'luck.'
- 19. a.** One should always be willing to admit mistakes.
b. It's usually best to cover up one's mistakes.
- 20. a.** It is hard to know whether or not a person really likes you.
b. How many friends you have depends on how nice a person you are.



CIRCLE OF CONCERN VS CIRCLE OF CONTROL

- 21. a.** In the long term, the bad things that happen to us are balanced out with the good ones.
b. Most misfortunes come about as a result of lack of ability, laziness, ignorance, or all three.
- 22. a.** With sufficient effort, we can abolish political corruption.
b. It's difficult for people to have much control over the things that politicians do in office.
- 23. a.** Sometimes I can't comprehend how teachers arrive at the grades they give.
b. There's a direct connection between how hard I study and the grades that I get.
- 24. a.** A good leader expects people to make their own decisions about what they should do.
b. A good leader makes it clear to everyone what their jobs are.
- 25. a.** Frequently, I feel that I have little influence over the things that happen to me.
b. It's impossible for me to believe that luck or chance plays a significant role in my life.
- 26. a.** Individuals are lonely because they don't try to be friendly.
b. There's not much use in trying too hard to please others, if they like you, they like you.
- 27. a.** There's too much emphasis on sports in high school.
b. Team sports are an excellent way of building character.
- 28. a.** What happens to me is my own doing.
b. At times I feel I don't have enough control over the direction my life is heading.
- 29. a.** The majority of the time I can't understand why politicians behave the way that they do.
b. In the long term, the people are responsible for a bad government on a national as well as on a local level.

Scoring: Score one point for each of the following: 2.a, 3.b, 4.b, 5.b, 6.a, 7.a, 9.a, 10.b, 11.b, 12.b, 13.b, 15.b, 16.a, 17.a, 18.a, 20.a, 21.a, 22.b, 23.a, 25.a, 26.b, 28.b, 29.a.

A higher score = External Locus of Control

A lower score = Internal Locus of Control

